

Dimitria Freitas

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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, TU Dresden	Oct 2020 – Mar 2027 (expected)
<i>Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Alexander Kemnitz (TU Dresden), Prof. Dr. Gabriel Ahlfeldt (Humboldt University)</i>	
M.A. in International Relations, TU Dresden	2016 – 2019
B.A. in Business Administration, DHBW Mannheim	2013 – 2016

Academic Positions

Researcher, Thuenen Institute & Humboldt University	Apr 2026 – present
<i>Chair of Econometrics, Humboldt University Berlin</i>	
Visiting Ph.D. Student, Humboldt University Berlin	Apr 2025 – Mar 2026
Visiting Ph.D. Student, University of Barcelona	Oct 2023 – Dec 2023
Research Associate, TU Dresden	Oct 2020 – Sep 2026
<i>Chair of Economic Policy and Economic Research</i>	

Previous Employment

SAP SE, Germany and Singapore	Sep 2013 – Aug 2021
• Senior Solution Specialist, Global Public Services	Jan 2021 – Aug 2021
• Solution Specialist, Global Public Services	Jan 2019 – Dec 2020
• Working Master's Student, Global Public Services	Oct 2016 – Dec 2018
• Working Bachelor's Student, dual study programme	Sep 2013 – Sep 2016

Selected work: developed a public-sector digital-readiness index covering 151 countries and SAP's China Public Services strategy; engaged with visiting ministerial delegations.

Research Interests

Labour economics, Urban economics, public economics and political economy

Job Market Paper

The Effect of Public Sector Relocations on Regional Development in Germany

SOLE Best Poster Award, 6th World Labor Conference, Toronto, 2025

As regional economic disparities within countries grow, governments are increasingly experimenting with public employment reallocation as a place-based policy. In this paper, I estimate the causal effect on local labour markets of a German policy that plans to reallocate about 5,200 public sector jobs to lagging regions. Using novel data on agency relocations from 2015–2024, I estimate employment effects for receiving and sending municipalities. I find that both sending and receiving locations gain private employment. I rationalize these results in a quantitative spatial model, in which I estimate the public sector's contribution to private-sector agglomeration economies to be about 60% of the contribution of private-sector employment.

Book Chapters

- Freitas, D. (2026). The Potential of Public Employment Reallocation as a Place-Based Policy. In *The Economics of Place-Based Policies*, edited by Cécile Gaubert, Gordon H. Hanson, and David Neumark, chap. 7. Chicago: University of Chicago Press.

Working Papers

- Do Place-Based Policies Matter at the Poll? (with Luisa Dörr and Florian Dorn)
Using a German state relocation programme, we find that the governing party gains about

two percentage points in state elections and support for the far-right AfD falls, while turnout declines after relocations.

- The Drivers of Far-Right Populism in Western Countries (with Patrick Zwerschke)
- A Comment on Xu (2022): “Reshaping Global Trade: The Immediate and Long-Term Effects of Bank Failures” (with Guillaume Bérard and Priyam Verma). *I4R Discussion Paper* No. 85.

Work in Progress

- The Growth–Affordability Trade-off in Zoning (with Gabriel Ahlfeldt, Jan Bakker, and Nina Gläser)

We develop and quantify a spatial general equilibrium model to study growth–affordability trade-offs in land-use zoning. The model is disciplined using a unique micro-geographic dataset covering commercial and residential rents, employment, and wages for all of Germany. Counterfactual simulations show that constraining residential supply lowers office rents, fosters agglomeration and productivity, and raises output, but increases housing costs and harms low-skilled workers. Conversely, prioritizing residential development improves affordability and benefits low-skilled households, yet dampens productivity and wage growth. Our results highlight fundamental distributional trade-offs embedded in zoning policy and their implications for welfare and inequality.

Policy Papers

- Freitas, D., Syga, S. (2022). “35 cents less for gasoline and 17 cents less for diesel – The fuel tax reduction was passed on to consumers, on average.” *ifo Dresden berichtet*, 29, 13–18.
Cited in policy reports by the Bundeskartellamt (Federal Cartel Office), refinery-sector inquiry and the Monopolies Commission, report to the German Bundestag. Media coverage: DNN.

Seminars & Conferences

- **2026:** IAB Research Colloquium (invited); Max Planck Institute for Tax Law and Public Finance (invited); LSE Early Career Women in Economic Geography and Spatial Economics; SOEP Brown Bag; UEA Summer School; IZA/LISER Summer School; Berlin PhD Seminar in Economics; EALE 2026; UEA North American Meeting
- **2025:** CEPR Paris Symposium (poster); CREST Urban PhD Workshop; Public Economics Colloquium Leipzig (invited); 6th World Labor Conference (poster); European Public Choice Society Meeting; 14th UEA European Meeting
- **2024:** NBER Conference on the Economics of Place-Based Policies; Aix-Marseille Research Seminar (invited); RSA Annual Conference; 13th UEA European Meeting; Annual Congress of the Swiss Society of Economics and Statistics; AQR Barcelona Research Seminar (invited)
- **2023:** IEB Barcelona Work in Progress Seminar; 13th ifo Dresden Workshop on Regional Economics; 10th CGDE Doctoral Workshop
- **2022:** 12th ifo Dresden Workshop on Regional Economics

Teaching

Instructor, independently designed seminars, TU Dresden

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| • Game Theory Experiments with Large Language Models | Summer 2025 |
| • Economics of Innovation, Automation, and Artificial Intelligence | Summer 2024 |
| • The New Age of AI – The Impact of ChatGPT on Labour Market Outcomes | Winter 2023/24 |
| • Current Topics in Economic Policy (Bachelor level) | Summer 2022 |
| • Fake News, Media Bias and Voting Behaviour (Master level) | Winter 2021/22 |
| • Economics of Populism (Master level) | Winter 2020/21 |
| • Introduction to International Institutions (Bachelor level) | Winter 2020/21 |

Teaching assistant, tutorials

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| • Introduction to Econometrics, HU Berlin; about 70 students per week | Summer 2026 |
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- Economics of Inequality (Bachelor level), TU Dresden; about 30 students Summer 2023
- Microeconomics (Bachelor level), TU Dresden; about 70 students per week Summer 2021

Supervision, TU Dresden

- Supervision of 10+ bachelor's and master's theses Winter 2020/21 – Winter 2025/26
- Research seminar in economic policy (Master level) Winter 2020/21 – Winter 2025/26

Ph.D. Coursework

Coursework in quantitative spatial economics, causal inference, advanced microeconomics, advanced econometrics, labour economics, development economics, and machine learning, including training at the Berlin School of Economics, LSE, Oxford University, IWH Halle, and TU Dresden.

Fellowships & Awards

- Society of Labor Economists (SOLE) Best Poster Award, 6th World Labor Conference 2025
- Erasmus+ Travel Grant 2023
- TU Dresden Graduate Academy Travel Grant 2022
- Award for Best Bachelor Thesis, in collaboration with SAP 2016
- Scholarship, German National Academic Foundation (Studienstiftung) 2013 – 2016

Languages

German and Portuguese (bilingual), English (C1–C2), French (B2–C1), Spanish (B2–C1), Russian (A1–A2)

Technical Skills

Stata, R, Python, SQL, $\text{\LaTeX}$, MATLAB

Academic Service

Referee for <i>Regional Science and Urban Economics</i> and <i>Regional Studies</i>	2026 – present
Organiser, Berlin Quantitative Spatial Economics Seminars, HU Berlin	2025 – 2026
Editorial Board Chair, <i>PolisReflects</i> (student-led journal)	2020 – 2022
Speaker for Non-Tenured Research Staff, TU Dresden	2020 – 2021

References

Prof. Dr. Alexander Kemnitz

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Prof. Dr. Gabriel Ahlfeldt

Humboldt University Berlin
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Jan Bakker

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20136 Milan, Italy
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